

Boat Airdopes ProClip

An open-ear design that gets the basics right

Open-ear earbuds have created their niche, and you have plenty of options in the market. At the same time, they have a very different proposition from regular TWS earbuds. They don't seal the ear canal. In practice, when you sport open-ear earbuds, you get ambient awareness but no form of noise cancellation. Now, for those who want this kind of earphones, Boat has launched the Airdopes ProClip. It features the clip-on design, 12mm dynamic drivers, Bluetooth 6.0, multipoint connectivity, a claimed 52-hour battery life, 55ms low latency, and AI-powered Environmental Noise Cancellation for calls. All at an asking price of a rather modest Rs 1799.

I have been wearing the Boat Airdopes ProClip for a week now, and here's how it fared as my primary buds for music, movies, calls, and navigation instructions, while keeping me aware of my surroundings.

BOAT AIRDOPES PROCLIP: DESIGN AND BUILD

Our Boat Airdopes ProClip review unit has a chic Velvet Wine colour and a matte finish. The other two options are Silk Grey and Satin White. The buds have a flexible C-shaped bridge between their two modules. The smaller module has the driver and sits in front of the ear, and the battery and controls are present in the other module, which sits behind the ear. While it is very light and the bridge ensures the earbuds don't fall off even during workouts, occasionally, after several hours of wearing them, I did feel mild pressure.

₹1,799



Features 7.5
Performance 7.2
Build 7.8
Value for Money...8.5

Thankfully, wearing them and removing them is easy. So, whether it is because of fatigue, rain, or while washing my face, I could easily take them off. By the way, because of IPX4

ingress protection, the buds can withstand some splash. Also, you can keep them and still hear your neighbours talking to you, even if music is playing. But to have a conversation, the music will need to be stopped.

BOAT AIRDOPES PROCLIP: CONNECTIVITY AND APP CONTROLS

For pairing, the user has to open the Boat Airdopes ProClip case and press the button on the back of the case for a few seconds. Choose it in your device's Bluetooth settings. That's it. You can start using it, or if you want to tweak any settings, use the Boat Hearables app. The app will take a second initially to register the connection.

The connection stayed stable throughout my use. You get Bluetooth

multipoint support, too, enabled by default. You can connect to two devices at a time, but playback on the first device needs to be paused for audio to be heard from the second device.

You can find Multipoint and other settings within the Boat Hearables app. The app needs you to log in with a mobile number and an email ID, by the way. Also, the app asks you where you purchased the earbuds from and offers you complementary Spotify and JioSaavn subscriptions.

Inside, you get to see the battery status and basic tweaking options. The two primary settings I found useful were that you can choose and change the 10-band EQ and configure the touch controls.

You have to tap the module present on the back of the ear to trigger the touch controls. It works decently but takes a sweet second to register. Sometimes, that can be annoying.

There's also a Beast Mode that is said to reduce the latency to 55ms. This worked alright for gaming and watching dialogue-heavy content on screen.

BOAT AIRDOPES PROCLIP: SOUND QUALITY

Let me tell you right away that the sound experience from the Boat open-earbuds was nice and better than my expectations. It is fairly airy with ample clarity for vocals, instruments, and respectable weight for bass.

I vividly remember the atmospheric feel I got while listening to Snehithine cover by Masala Coffee on YouTube Music. The vocals by the band's lead singer, Sooraj Santhosh, and the violin strings reached high notes impressively. The different instruments could also be heard from different positions, showcasing the earbuds' better-than-expected sound staging.

Since open-ear earbuds do not seal the ear canal, they cannot deliver the same low-frequency impact as in-ear earbuds. Still, the bass drops in songs such as Like This by Miss Tyka were